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GovErNing human rights through partnErShIpS:
rights at the interface of multistakeholder governance & international law

Appendix 2: Methodological Sheet

of the GENESIS Database on Multistakeholder Partnerships for Sustainable Development

Work Package 4 – GENESIS Project

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	Methodological Sheet
Working Package 4 – GENESIS Project	Database on Multistakeholder Partnerships for Sustainable Development: Food, Health, Education and Water. Database development period: 18 April 2024 – 15 December 2025

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Abstract	This publication presents the design and development of the Database on Multistakeholder Partnerships (MSPs) for Sustainable Development of the ERC-funded GENESIS research project. This Database was created to empirically map existing projects contributing to the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and then assess the participation and involvement of MSPs in such projects. The Database was constructed to support Work Package 4 of the GENESIS project, which investigates how MSPs engage with international human rights standards in delivering collective goods and services associated with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Drawing primarily on the UN DESA SDG Partnerships Platform and complemented by additional sources, the dataset compiles 3,977 projects and applies a structured three-step Data Scraping Protocol to identify partnerships that qualify as MSPs—defined as networked arrangements involving public, private, and civil society actors—and that operate as long-term initiatives focused on SDGs 2 (food), 3 (health), 4 (education), or 6 (water). Using this method, 160 projects implemented by MSPs were identified for further analysis in this research project. However, the complete dataset of projects (either implemented by MSPs or other actors) is published open access to ensure it meets the data management FAIR criteria: findable, accessible, interoperable, and reusable. The resulting workbook offers a systematically curated set of projects, initiatives and partnerships operating in these four

	SDG domains and serves as a foundational resource for examining their governance practices, accountability gaps, and engagement with human rights norms, while also providing a versatile research tool for broader studies.
Search Key Words	Multistakeholder Partnerships (MSPs); Sustainable Development; Human Rights; Global Governance; Food; Health; Education; Water.
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Spreadsheet Variables	
Variable	Description
Project Number	The project number is a unique numerical identifier that was assigned by the researcher to each project for precise reference. Each row of the spreadsheet contains a single project associated to a number listed in ascending order.
Project SDGs	For the projects drawn from the SDG Actions Platform from United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UN DESA), this variable contains the list of all the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to which each project claims to contribute. Although the database only collects the projects allegedly contributing to the SDGs 2 (Food), 3 (Health), 4 (Education), and 6 (Water) — for this is the scope of the GENESIS research project— this does not mean that projects cannot contribute to multiple goals simultaneously, which is why multiple SDGs may appear listed under this variable. The contribution to an SDG may be direct or indirect, depending on each project's own perception of its scope of work. Thus, even though all the projects included in the Database claim to contribute to at least one of the four SDGs targeted in the GENESIS project, it is possible that this contribution is only incidental or secondary and that, in fact, another SDG is the main target and focus of the project. This distinction is then addressed in the "SDG Scope" variable of the Data Scraping Protocol. To complement the information derived from the UN DESA Platform and ensure the inclusion of partnerships that were not recorded therein, the researcher consulted other documents on partnerships for sustainable development (as shown in the "Source" variable below) to identify additional partnerships. In the case of these partnerships identified in other sources of information, this variable was determined by reviewing each partnership's own website and available information.

- The OECD's Inclusive Development Partnerships 2025.
https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/development-co-operation-tips-tools-insights-practices_be69e0cf-en/inclusive-development-partnerships_15aea1cd-en.html
- OECD Science, Technology and Innovation Policy—STIP Compass Multi-stakeholder engagement Policy theme dashboard.
<https://stip.oecd.org/stip/interactive-dashboards/themes/TH65>
- The Partnership Snapshot from the 2025 ECOSOC Partnership Forum.
<https://sdgs.un.org/2025ECOSOCPartnershipForum>
- The Small Island Developing States Partnership Framework (SIDS) Partnership Framework (guided by the UN General Assembly Steering Committee on Partnerships for SIDS):
 - SIDS Partnership Framework Background.
<https://sdgs.un.org/topics/small-island-developing-states/sids-partnership-framework#background>
 - SIDS Partnership Guide.
<https://partnershipaccelerator.org/library/?module=sids#>
 - The article “Strengthening Civil Society Engagement and Partnerships for the implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda”. <https://sdgs.un.org/SIDS/CSOStudy2025>
- The UN Water Action Agenda Concept Note.
https://sdgs.un.org/sites/default/files/2022-11/Water_Action_Agenda_operations_concept_note.pdf
- Academic literature and publications

**All these sources were lastly consulted on 26 November 2025*

Status

The Status variable indicates the final result of a three-step Data Scraping Protocol designed to identify which projects in the Database were relevant to the GENESIS research scope. This variable contains only two possible values:

- “Checked-In” – the project met all three criteria of the Protocol.
- “Checked-Out” – the project failed at least one of the criteria when assessed in sequential order.

The three criteria used to determine the Status of each project are recorded separately in the variables that follow: ‘Type of Partnership’, ‘Type of Project’, and ‘SDG Scope’. A project was marked Checked-In only if it satisfied all three criteria. If it did not satisfy one of them, it was classified as Checked-Out, and the subsequent criteria were not applied further.

Originally, the assessment process used a traffic-light system with colour-coding green, yellow, and red. In each variable, green would indicate that the project met the criterion (“fully in”), yellow would temporarily mean uncertainty about the classification, but would ultimately turn green or red; and red would indicate that a project did not meet the criterion (“fully out”). However, the decisive information for database users is the text contained in each of the three variables (e.g., “MSP”, “INI”, or a specific SDG number), which indicates whether the project fulfilled that step of the Protocol. This is particularly important for users visualising the .csv format in which colours do not show. The text labelling will be detailed in the three variables below.

**Projects that did not meet the three criteria —and therefore classified as Checked-Out— remain in the Database for potential use in future research,*

even though they were not included in later stages of Work Package 4 of the GENESIS project.

Type of Partnership

This variable identifies the type of actor implementing each project. Its purpose is to determine whether the project was carried out by a Multistakeholder partnership (MSP). The values in this column correspond to six possible labels, each identifying a specific type of partnership structure:

- 'MSP' = Multistakeholder Partnership

A partnership qualifies as an MSP only if it includes at least three types of actors: (1) a public-sector actor, (2) a private-sector actor, and (3) a civil society organisation (CSO). Only projects implemented by partnerships meeting this three-actor criterion satisfy this step of the Protocol.

- 'CP' = Corporate Partnership

A partnership involving one or more corporate actors but not meeting the three-actor requirement of an MSP.

- 'PP' = Public-Private Partnership

A collaboration between public-sector and private-sector actors, but without the involvement of a CSO and therefore not an MSP.

- 'CC' = Corporate–CSO Partnership

A partnership involving corporate and civil society actors, but lacking a public-sector actor, and thus not an MSP.

- 'PuPu' = Public–Public Partnership

A collaboration exclusively among public-sector actors, which does not meet the MSP criteria.

- 'Other'

Any other type of partnership or single actor, but not an MSP. This label is used for cases that do not fall neatly into the categories above or when the project is implemented by a single entity. Even if the type of actor(s) could be identified, the datapoint was classified as 'other' if its structure clearly does not constitute an MSP.

If the cell in this variable is labelled "MSP", the project meets the first criterion and proceeds to the next stage of the Data Scraping Protocol (Type of Project). If the cell is labelled CP, PP, CC, PuPu, or Other, the project is automatically classified as Checked-Out in the Status variable. In such cases, the remaining two criteria (Type of Project and SDG Scope) are not assessed further. Even when a project did not meet this criterion, it was retained in the Database for potential use in other research.

Type of Project

This variable categorises each project according to its structure, duration, and degree of institutionalisation. For the purposes of the GENESIS project, only long-term structured initiatives (those that had already been determined to be implemented by MSPs) were included.

The variable contains the following labels:

- 'INI' = Long-term Initiative

These are structured, continuous, and often institutionalised collaborations designed to operate over an extended period (at least one year of duration).

	Projects labelled INI satisfy this criterion and proceed to the next stage of the Protocol (SDG Scope). - 'PR' = Short-term Project These are organised sets of activities or interventions, usually with a defined timeframe, usually less than a year, but without the permanence, institutionalisation, or open-ended duration expected of an INI. Programmes may have clear objectives and structure but are ultimately time-bound and therefore do not meet this criterion. - EV = Single Event (One-off or Episodic) These are one-off or episodic activities, such as conferences, workshops, campaigns, among others. These lack the long-term institutional characteristics and therefore do not meet this criterion. Projects labelled "INI" satisfy the second criterion and proceed to assessment under SDG Scope. Projects labelled "PR" or "Ev" do not satisfy the criterion and are automatically classified as Checked-Out in the Status variable. All projects, however, remain in the Database for transparency and potential future research purposes, even though they were not included in later stages of Work Package 4 of the GENESIS project.
SDG Scope	This variable identifies the main Sustainable Development Goal(s) targeted by each project. It records the SDG(s) that represent the project's primary focus, not those to which the project contributes only indirectly. In fact, the purpose of this step is to determine which of the SDGs indicated in the "Project SDGs" variable best described the project's scope of work. The GENESIS project focuses on four SDGs: 2 (food), 3 (health), 4 (education), and 6 (water). This variable computes only the number of the main targeted SDG and, if more than one, the numbers appear in ascending order separated by commas. Any other SDG number (e.g., SDG 14 or 15) means the project's main focus lies outside the GENESIS scope and does not satisfy the criterion. Combined with the previous steps, only projects meeting all three criteria appear as Checked-In in the Status variable.
Description	This variable contains each project's own brief summary of its main activities, objectives, and scope of work. The descriptions were extracted from the UN DESA Platform exactly as registered by each project. However, some projects did not include a description when completing the UN DESA registration form, and therefore the cell appears empty (marked with a hyphen) for this variable. For partnerships identified through other sources of information, the researcher drafted a project description based on the information available on the partnership's website and in publicly accessible documents.
Start Date	This variable corresponds to the project's starting date as indicated in the UN DESA Platform. Projects with "01 January 1970" as the start or end date mean that they did not record this information, and the Platform assigned this date by default. Caution should be exercised when reviewing these projects with inconsistent dates. On a similar note, other projects have entered "N/A" (not applicable) in this variable at the time of registration on the Platform and,

	therefore, the actual start or end date remains unknown and would require further investigation. For partnerships identified through other information sources, the research team determined the start date using details from organizational websites and publicly available documents. When the exact date was unclear, an approximate date was established through reasoned estimation and contrast between different source materials.
End Date	This variable corresponds to the project's completion date as indicated in the UN DESA Platform. Caution should be exercised when reviewing projects with the "01 January 1970" default date assigned by the Platform. For partnerships identified through other sources, the research team determined the end date using details from their websites and public documents. When such information was unclear, an approximate date was established based on reasoned estimation and contrast of different sources.
Partners	This variable lists the members or stakeholders involved in each project's implementation, as indicated in the UN DESA Platform. The variable contains participating organizations and legal entities, but not natural persons or individual members. Since some projects did not provide this information when completing the registration form, certain cells may appear empty (marked with a hyphen) for this variable. In the case of partnerships identified in other sources of information, the researcher compiled the list of partners based on information available on their websites and in publicly available documents.
Info Link	This variable contains the URL directing to each project's own website. In some cases, projects do not have an independent website and are instead hosted on the main implementing partner's website. Some URLs lead to general information webpages from which users must navigate to find the specific project. For projects listed in the UN DESA Platform, this information was self-registered, while for partnerships identified elsewhere, the researcher located the appropriate info link.
Project Link	This URL directs to each project's webpage on the UN DESA Platform, representing the original project entry from which each datapoint was scraped. This variable does not apply to partnerships identified through other sources of information that are not hosted in the UN DESA Platform. In such cases, this variable is labelled "N/A" (not applicable).